

Note Pad

for Android

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Table of Contents

1	The Basics	1
1.1	Device Compatibility	1
1.2	Permissions	1
1.3	Adding Notes	1
1.4	Editing Notes	1
1.5	Deleting Notes	1
2	Categorizing Notes	3
3	Private Notes	5
3.1	Lost Password	6
4	Exporting and Importing	12
4.1	Exporting Notes	12
4.1.1	Exporting to a ZIP File	15
4.2	Importing Notes	17
4.2.1	Importing from a ZIP File	20
4.3	Exporting a Single Note	20
4.4	Importing a Single Note	21
5	Known Bugs	22

1 The Basics

Note Pad was designed to be simple and intuitive, so you should be able to get started writing notes without using this manual.

1.1 Device Compatibility

The application is designed for compatibility with Android 15 (Vanilla Ice Cream) but also runs on Android 5.0 (Lollipop) through 16 (Baklava) which should cover 99.8% of Android devices on the market as of May 2026. (It has been tested on Lollipop, Marshmallow, Nougat, Oreo, Quince Tart, Snow Cone, Tiramisu, Upside-down Cake, Vanilla Ice Cream, and Baklava.) Support for newer Android devices is planned.

1.2 Permissions

When installing the NotePad app or when using certain features, Android may ask you to grant permission for the app to access some system-level functions. The permission the app requests is:

- Write files to external storage (Marshmallow or earlier). The app uses this on older Android devices when you export your NotePad data to a file for backup or transfer. In Android 6 (Marshmallow), this is only needed if you select a backup file location outside of the app's private folder. In Android 7 (Nougat) and later, this permission is not required since the app uses Android's Storage Access Framework.

1.3 Adding Notes

To add a new note, press “New”, then start typing the note.

When finished writing the note, press “Done”. The first line of the note is shown in the notes list.

1.4 Editing Notes

To make changes to an existing note, tap on the note heading. After editing the note, press “Done”.

If you want to discard your changes to the note, press the Back button. The app will ask you to confirm whether you want to discard the changes. If you pressed Back by accident, you can press “Cancel” to return to editing your note.

1.5 Deleting Notes

If you no longer need a note, there are two ways to delete it. Tap the note heading to enter the editor.

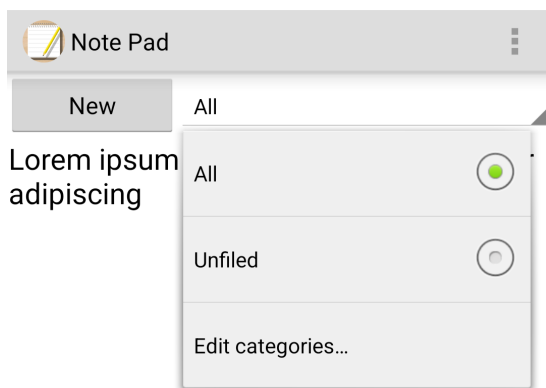
The first way is to press Details . . . → Delete.

The second is to delete all of the text of the note, then press Done. The app removes any empty note.

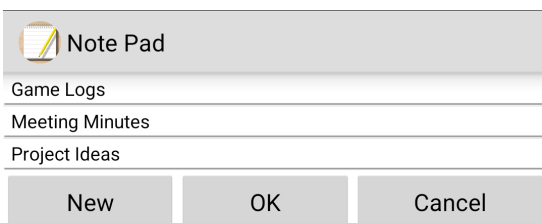
2 Categorizing Notes

Each note can be assigned to a different category, allowing you to organize your notes.

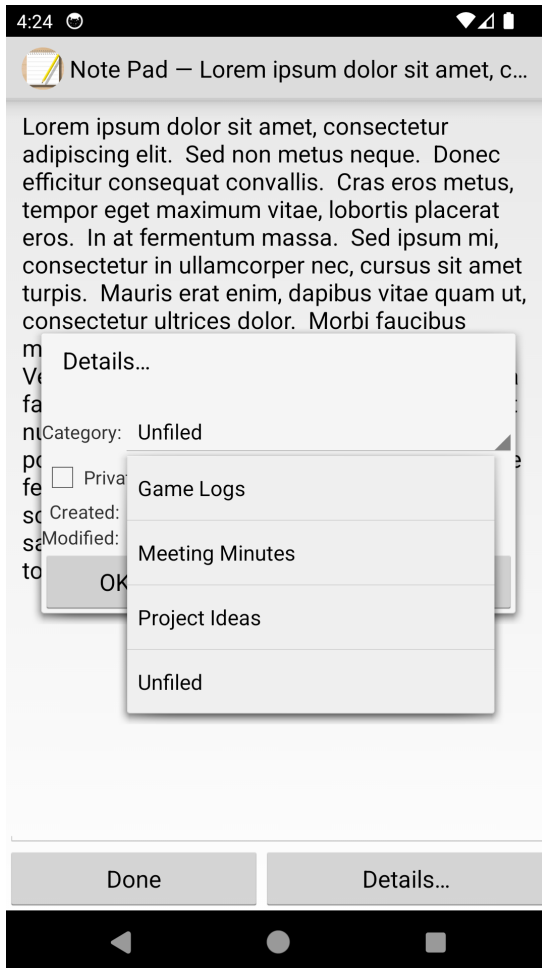
When the application is first installed it comes with just one category, “Unfiled”, and all new notes will be in this category. To add new categories, open the category drop-down list next to the “New” button, then select “Edit categories...”.



From the next screen, press “New” to make a new line in the category list, then enter the name of the category right on that page. Repeat for every category you want to create. You can also change previously entered categories on this page. When finished, press “OK” to save the new category list, or “Cancel” to discard your changes.



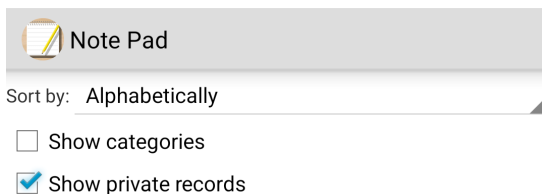
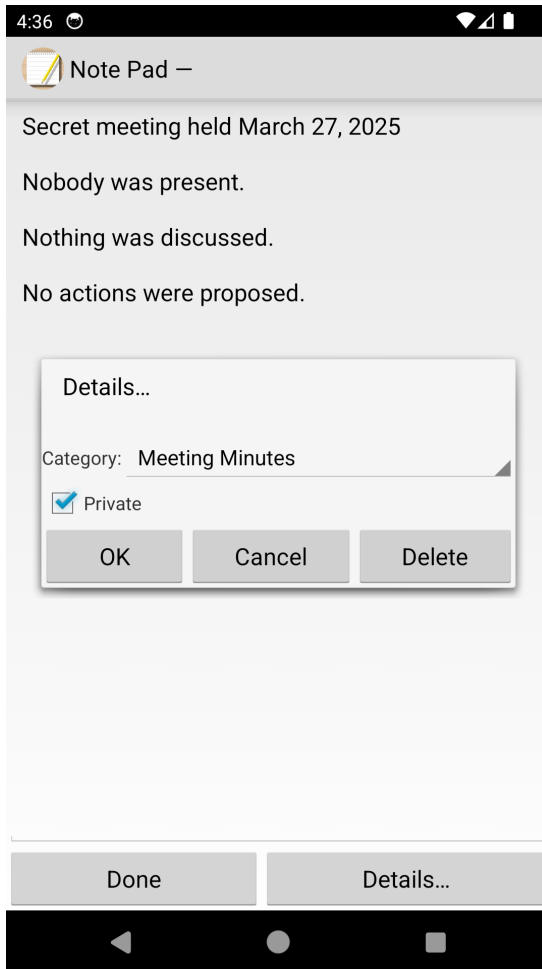
Now when you create or edit a note, you will have the option of changing the category it is assigned to by going to the “Details...” dialog.



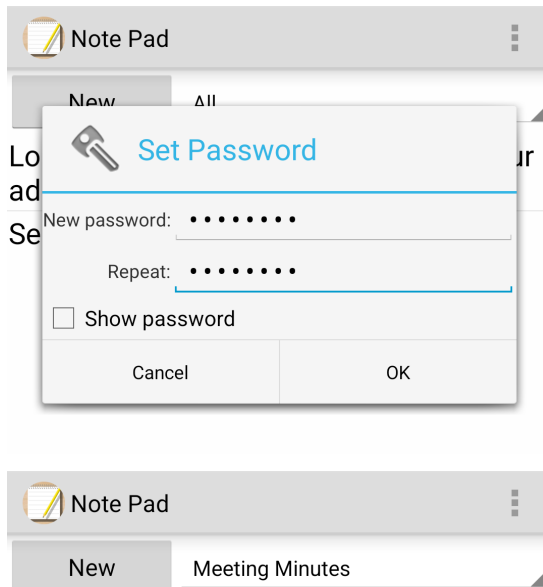
On the note list, open the category drop-down and select one of your custom categories to show only the notes in that category. New notes will default to the currently selected category. If you select “All”, then notes from all categories will be shown.

3 Private Notes

Notes can be marked as “Private”, in which case they are normally hidden in your list of notes unless you turn on “Show private records” in the application settings. To make a note private, open the “Details. . .” dialog from the note editor and check the “Private” box.



You can add an extra layer of security to your private notes by setting a password from the application's main menu. After setting a password, all of your private notes will be encrypted and will show up as “[Locked]” in your note list and you will not be able to edit them until you enter your password in the application settings. When you exit the application, it forgets your password so that the private notes become locked again the next time anybody opens your Note Pad.



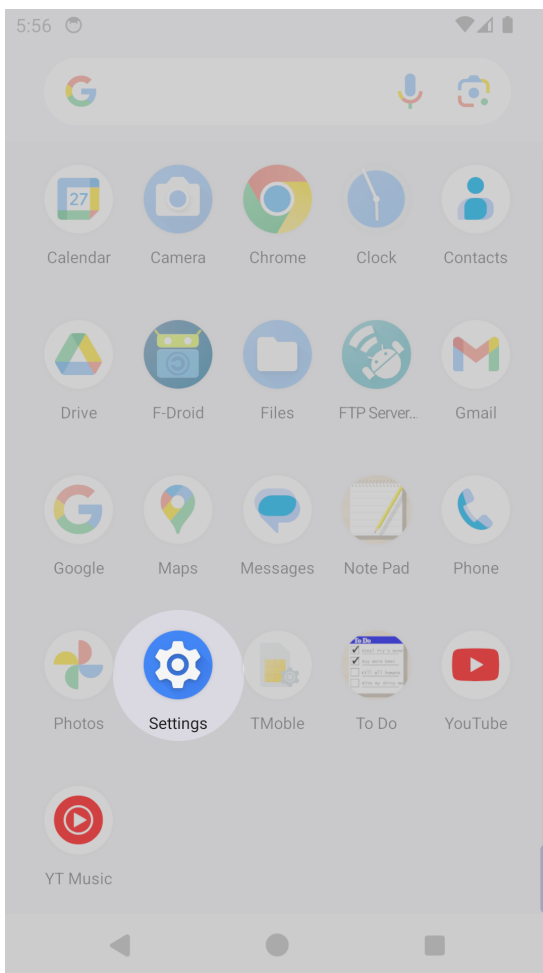
Important! If you have not entered your password in the application settings and you mark a note as Private, it will *not* be encrypted. If you want to encrypt a new note but have not entered your password yet, simply save it, enter your password in the application settings, open up your new note and save it again.

You can remove your password and un-encrypt your private notes by choosing “Set Password” from the main menu, enter your old password, but leave the new password blank.

3.1 Lost Password

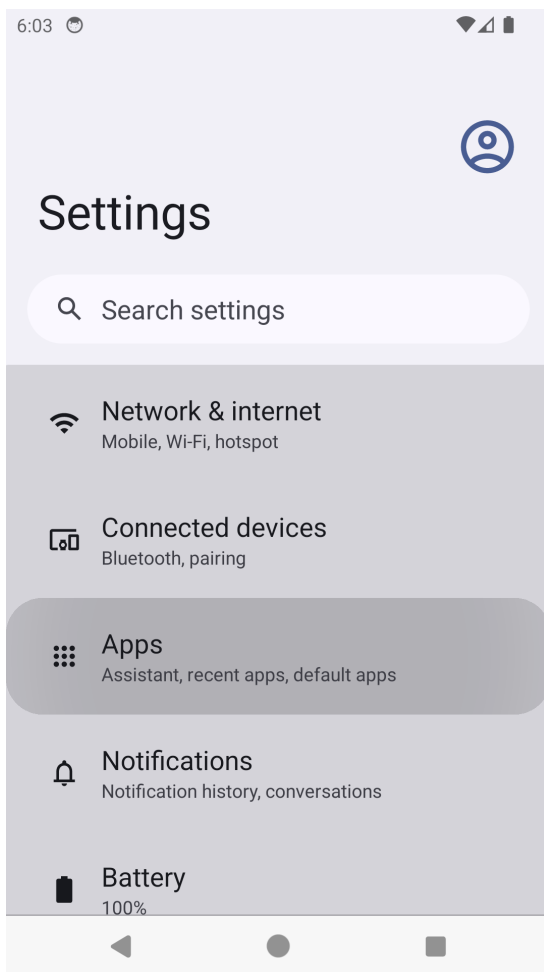
If you have set a password and later forget what it was, you will not be able to access your encrypted private notes. The only way to recover from this situation and reset your password is to erase the application data.

1. If you have any private notes which were *not* encrypted (because they were created without a password,) change them so they are not private.
2. Export a backup copy of your Note Pad data (see Section 4.1 [Exporting Notes], page 12), but *do not* include private notes.
3. Exit the Note Pad application, and open up the Android Settings.

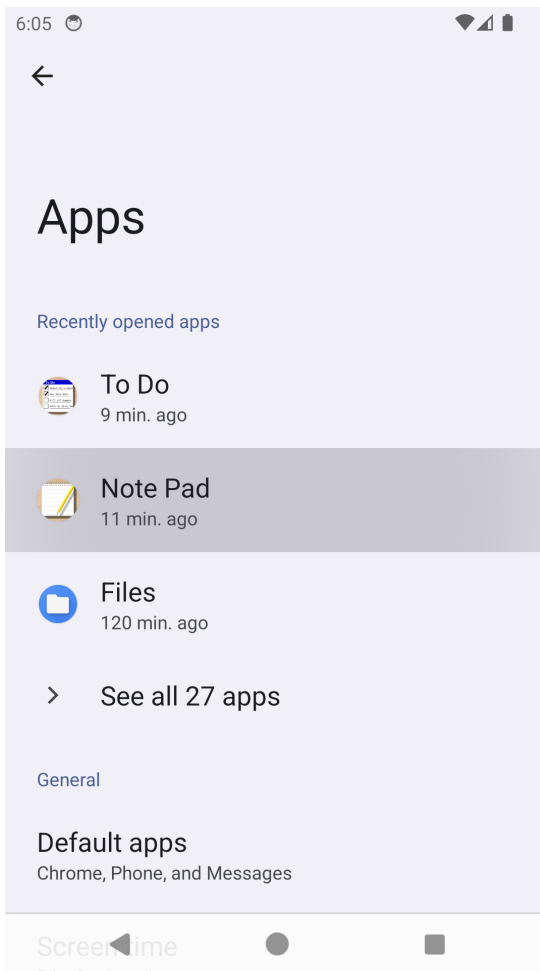


(The following sequence may vary depending on your version of Android.)

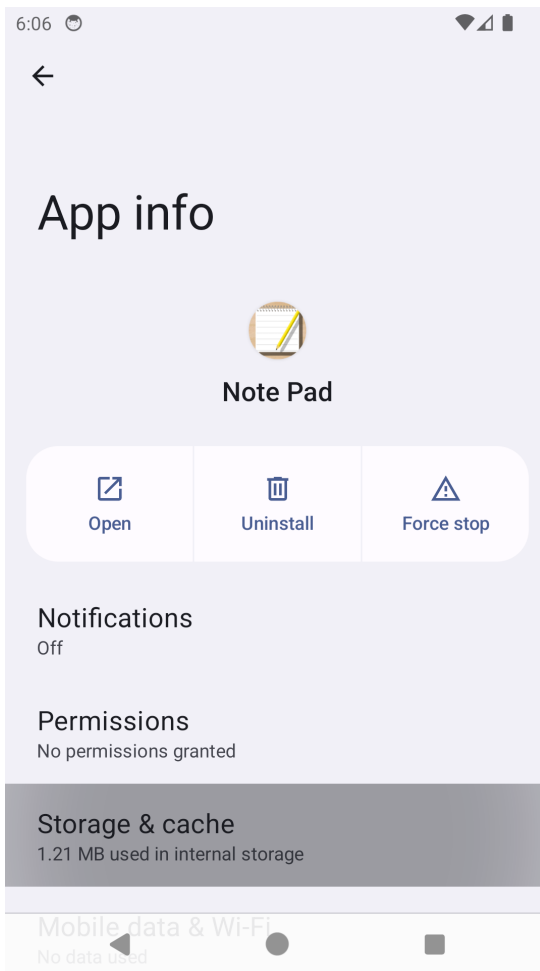
4. Choose “Apps”



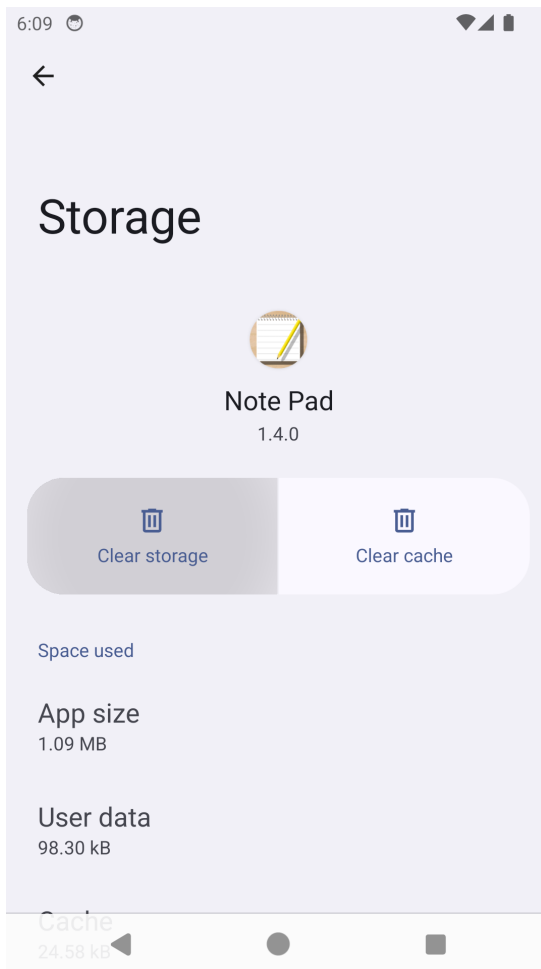
5. Choose “Note Pad”



6. Select “Storage & Cache”



7. Press the “Clear storage” button, and confirm that you really want to do this.

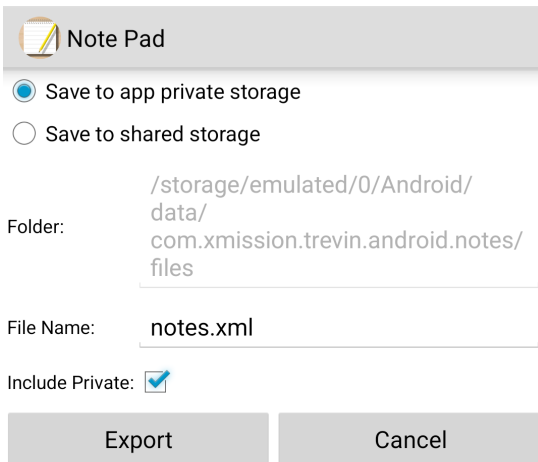


8. Exit all the way out of the Android Settings, and go back to the Note Pad application. It should now be empty.
9. Import the file you had previously backed up. (See Section 4.2 [Importing Notes], page 17)
10. If you had any notes which were private but not encrypted, change them back to private.
11. Set a new password. Make sure you remember this one!

4 Exporting and Importing

4.1 Exporting Notes

In order to protect against the loss of data on your Android device, you should periodically make a backup copy. First, if you have set a password for your private notes make sure you have entered the password in the “Settings” to unlock them. Then in the main menu select “Export Data” to save all of your notes to a file on your device.

A screenshot of the 'Note Pad' export dialog. At the top is a title bar with a notepad icon and the text 'Note Pad'. Below it are two radio buttons: 'Save to app private storage' (selected) and 'Save to shared storage'. Underneath is a text field for the folder path, showing '/storage/emulated/0/Android/data/com.xmission.trevin.android.notes/files'. Below that is a text field for the file name, containing 'notes.xml'. At the bottom left is a checkbox labeled 'Include Private:' which is checked. At the bottom are two buttons: 'Export' and 'Cancel'.

Note Pad

☒ Save to app private storage

☐ Save to shared storage

Folder: /storage/emulated/0/Android/data/com.xmission.trevin.android.notes/files

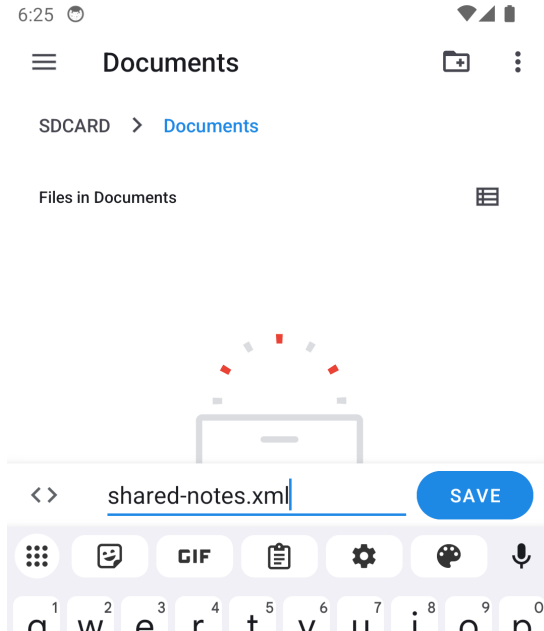
File Name: notes.xml

Include Private: ☒

Export Cancel

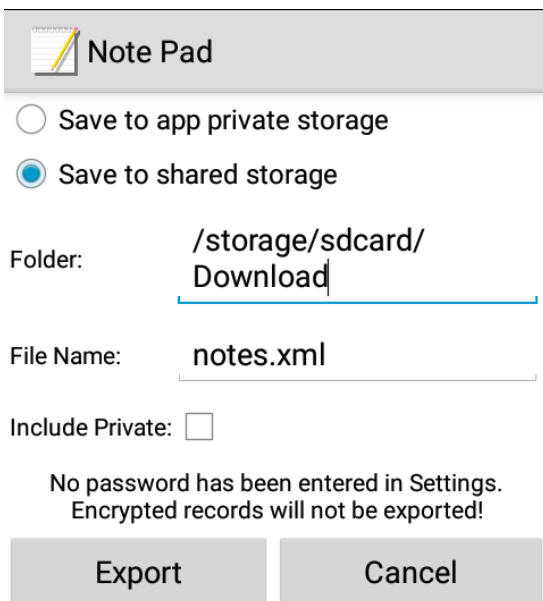
You can choose where to save the file and what to name it, but by default it is saved to the app’s private storage area on your device. The export dialog shows the location of this storage, which can vary depending on your version of Android — for example: /sdcard/Android/Data/com.xmission.trevin.android.notes/files.

If you select “Saved to shared storage”, you have the option to save it anywhere supported by Android’s Storage Access Framework if running Android 7 (Nougat) or newer. You will need to enter the name of the export file you wish to save, ending in either `.xml` or `.zip`.



After pressing “Save” you will return to the app’s Export screen.

If you are using Android 6 (Marshmallow) or older, selecting “Save to shared storage” will change the folder to the device’s default **Downloads** directory. You can change the location by typing it in, but be sure the location is accessible.



The image shows a dialog box titled "Note Pad" with a notepad icon. It contains two radio buttons: "Save to app private storage" (unselected) and "Save to shared storage" (selected). Below these are two text input fields: "Folder:" with the value "/storage/sdcard/Download" and "File Name:" with the value "notes.xml". There is an unchecked checkbox labeled "Include Private:". Below the checkbox is a warning message: "No password has been entered in Settings. Encrypted records will not be exported!". At the bottom are two buttons: "Export" and "Cancel".

Note Pad

☐ Save to app private storage

☒ Save to shared storage

Folder:

File Name:

Include Private: ☐

No password has been entered in Settings.
Encrypted records will not be exported!

Export Cancel

If you wish to include private notes in the exported file, be sure the “Include Private” box is checked. You can also export just the non-private notes by leaving this box unchecked. When ready, press “Export”. The app will show a progress bar as it writes the notes out (if it takes long enough) then return to the list.

4.1.1 Exporting to a ZIP File

If you have chosen to export your notes to a ZIP file (i.e. the file name ends in `.zip`), then you have several additional options.

☒ Save to shared storage

File Name:

Include Private: ☒

Category:

ZIP Encryption:

☐ No encryption

☐ Keep internal storage encryption (no decryption and re-encryption)

☒ AES with 128-bit key

☐ AES with 256-bit key

ZIP Password:

Show Password: ☐

First, you can choose whether to export notes in all categories or just those from a single category of notes. Categories other than “Unfiled” are written to the ZIP file as directories, with the notes being written into the directory for their category. “Unfiled” notes are written to the root level of the ZIP file. The name of each note file will be its internal ID number followed by “ - ”, the first line of the note (or as much as will fit), and the extension “.txt”.

Second, if you have selected to “Include Private” notes in the export, you can choose whether and how private notes are encrypted in the ZIP file. If you have set a password in the app, you can choose to export the encrypted notes as-is without decrypting and re-encrypting them; the file will be protected with the same password as the Note Pad app, and you do not need to unlock the encrypted notes first. However, these notes can *only* be read by the Note Pad app. If you choose “No encryption”, “ZipCrypto”, or “AES”, then encrypted notes must be unlocked first, but these options

are also available if you have not set a password for the app. When using “ZipCrypto” or “AES” you must provide a ZIP password to encrypt your private notes with, which does not need to be the same as the password for the Note Pad app. ZIP notes encrypted with “ZipCrypto” should be compatible with most ZIP file readers and operating systems, but **this is a very weak encryption method and should not be used when security is a concern**; it is only provided for the widest compatibility with older software. ZIP notes encrypted with “AES” should be compatible with many *modern* ZIP file readers, but generally requires installing 3rd-party software to read them.

- On Linux or MacOS, you may need to install a 7-Zip port (e.g. `p7zip`). The standard `unzip` command does not support AES decryption. ZipCrypto has been natively supported on MacOS since version 10.3 “Panther”; on earlier versions you will need to install a 3rd-party program like “Stuffit Expander”.
- On Windows, the file explorer cannot natively decrypt ZIP files encrypted with AES. You will need to install a 3rd-party program such as 7-Zip or WinZip. Files encrypted with ZipCrypto are supported by Windows XP or higher, and also Windows 98 with the “Plus! 98” pack.

4.2 Importing Notes

When you need to restore notes from your backup file, select “Import Data” from the main menu and select or enter the location of the file to import. If you are importing the notes you previously saved to the app’s private storage area, you will need to enter the same name that you gave the exported file.

 **Note Pad**

☒ File from app private storage
☐ File from shared storage

Folder:

File Name:

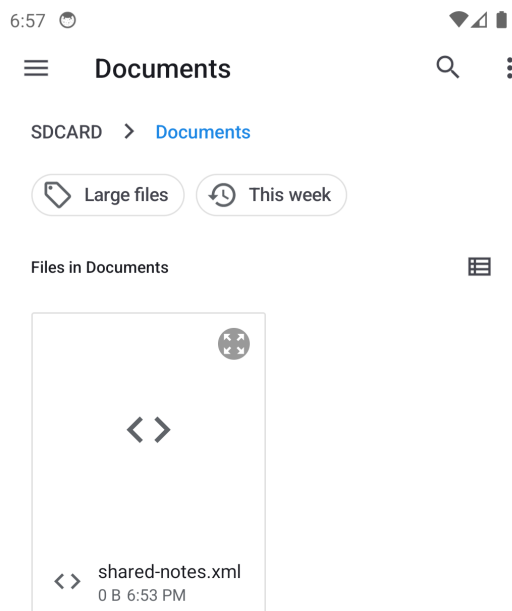
Import Type: 

Include Private: ☒

Saved Password:

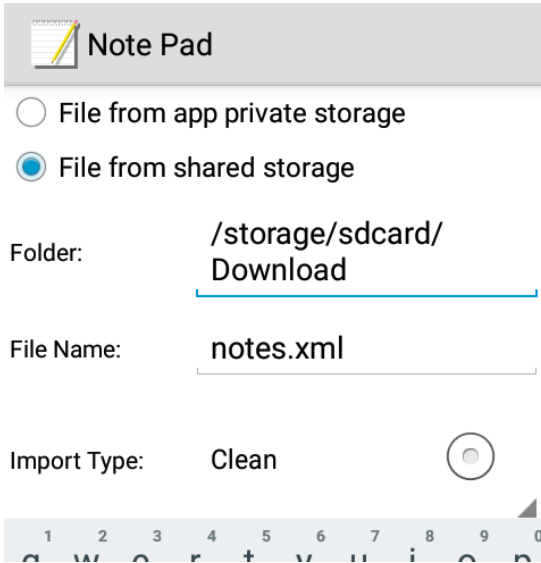
Show Password: ☐

If you are importing notes from a file in shared storage, select “File from shared storage”. On Android 7 (Nougat) or newer, you can browse through the available storage folders to find the `.xml` file with your saved notes.



When you select the document you will return to the app’s Import screen.

If you are using Android 6 (Marshmallow) or older, selecting “File from shared storage” will change the folder to the device’s default **Downloads** directory. You can change the location by typing it in, but you will need to know in advance where the file is located; the app doesn’t provide a file browser.



The screenshot shows the 'Note Pad' app interface. At the top is a header bar with a notepad icon and the title 'Note Pad'. Below the header are two radio buttons: 'File from app private storage' (unselected) and 'File from shared storage' (selected). Under the 'File from shared storage' option, there are three input fields: 'Folder:' containing '/storage/sdcard/Download', 'File Name:' containing 'notes.xml', and 'Import Type:' with a dropdown menu currently set to 'Clean'. At the bottom of the screen, a numeric keypad is visible, showing digits 1 through 0.

Next, select the type of import you wish to perform. The choices are:

- “Clean”: Use this when importing a backup file to a new device, or if you need to undo all changes which have been made since the file was exported. This will erase all of your notes and categories before importing notes from the file.
- “Overwrite”: This option will restore all notes from your backup file — even if the title has changed — but leave any new notes in the application alone.
- “Update”: This option will only import notes from the backup file whose modification time is newer than the corresponding note in the application database. Use this if you want to keep your notes on multiple devices, to synchronize changes between the two. If you update a note on both devices and then try to synchronize them with an update, the earlier changes will be lost in favor of the later ones.
- “Add”: This option will add all notes from the backup file as new notes, regardless of duplicates. This should be used if you created different sets of notes on separate devices and want to copy the notes from one to the other.
- “Test”: This option simply parses the backup file and reads all of its notes without importing any. Use this if you need to verify the integrity

of your backup file, particularly if you have manually edited it or had it created by a different application.

If you had set a password for your private notes when they were exported, you *will* need that password when you need to import those encrypted notes back in to the application. This may be different than your current password. **Important! Do not forget the password you had when you made the backup file.** Without that password, it will be practically impossible to recover your private notes; however you may still restore all of your non-private notes by un-checking “Include Private” on the Import form.

If you have not entered your password in the application settings when you attempt to import a backup file, the import form will warn you that any private notes imported will not be encrypted. You may either cancel the operation to enter your password in the settings and then try again, or go ahead and import the data and then re-encrypt the private notes later. To encrypt them afterward, either open up and save each private note individually, or choose “Set Password” from the main menu and change the password. (*You can change it to the same password if you wish.*)

4.2.1 Importing from a ZIP File

You can import notes from a ZIP file whether it was created by this app or another program. If the ZIP file was created by Note Pad, the import will work the same as importing a Note Pad XML file.

If your ZIP file was created by some other application, text files from the ZIP will be added as new notes regardless of the import type chosen. Files in the root folder will be placed in the “Unfiled” category, while those in a top-level folder will be assigned a category named as that folder. Files must contain only plain text encoded in ASCII or UTF-8; otherwise they will be skipped. (Files written with ISO-8859-*, Windows-125*, or other encodings are not accepted unless they contain only basic ASCII characters (<https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/ASCII>).)

4.3 Exporting a Single Note

On Android 7 (Nougat) and newer versions, you can save individual notes as plain text files. Open the note and click on the “Details...” button, then click “Export Note...”. Choose the folder where you want to save the file and enter a file name. (By convention, text files should end in “.txt”.) Then click “Save”.

If you try to export a private note which is encrypted, NotePad will warn you that the text file it is about to write will not be encrypted. You have the option to cancel the export at this time.

The app will show a brief message indicating that the file was written once it has finished.

4.4 Importing a Single Note

On Android 7 (Nougat) and newer versions, you can load plain text files into a note. Either create a new note or open an existing one; if you import a file into an existing note the file's content will be inserted at the cursor position. Click on the “Details. . .” button, then click “Import Note. . .”. Choose the file you want to insert. If successful, the file's content will be added into the note editor.

5 Known Bugs

The following bugs are known to exist in version 1.7.2 (build date 2026.06.11) of Note Pad. If you encounter any other bugs, please go to my project page on GitHub to report them:

<https://github.com/Typraeurion/Android-NotePad/issues>

- Under certain conditions in particular on Android 9+, selecting a different category on the note list page may not update the note list. This is an intermittent issue that was introduced as part of the refactoring done in version 1.5 and should not affect older versions. Until a fix can be confirmed, the workaround is to restart the app.
- When unlocking or locking encrypted records, the list of notes may not be properly updated right away especially on older devices. Encrypted entries should update their display when the list is scrolled or rotated.

The following bugs were in the 1.7.1 release (built 2026.05.10) but have been fixed as of 1.7.2 (built 2026.06.11).

- The export and import activities would cause the app to crash if the user had previously exported to or imported from a file in shared storage and permission to use that file has expired (e.g. after the app has been stopped or the device reboots.) This bug was introduced in version 1.7.0 with the addition of ZIP file support and does not impact older versions.

The following bugs were in the 1.7.0 release (built 2026.04.04) but have been fixed as of 1.7.1 (built 2026.05.10).

- When attempting to uninstall the app on an Android 10 (Quince Tart), 11 (Red Velvet Cake), or possibly 12 (Snow Cone) device, Android's package installer would crash in attempting to determine if the app had any data the user may wish to keep. This bug was introduced in version 1.4 (when targeting Android 12) so did not affect versions 1.3.2 and earlier.

The following bugs were in the 1.6.0 release (built 2026.03.18) but have been fixed as of 1.7.0 (built 2026.04.04).

- When running on Android 6 (Marshmallow) or earlier, there's a bug in the export service where if you try to back up the data to a new file it will fail. This bug was introduced with changes made in version 1.5 and does not affect older versions.
- When attempting to import a backup file in "Clean" mode, nothing gets imported even though the operation completes normally. This is a regression bug that was introduced in version 1.5 and does not affect older versions.
- With the scroll bar enabled, when text is added to or removed from a note the relative size of the scroll thumb changes as it should but the thumb's position was not properly set.

The following bugs were in the 1.5.1 release (built 2025.12.28) but have been fixed as of 1.6.0 (built 2026.03.18).

- When opening NotePad, the category list may reset to “All” instead of staying on the category that was selected the last time the app was used.
- When the editor is restarted due to a configuration change (e.g. rotating the screen, attaching or detaching an external keyboard) any changes made to your note will be lost.
- The amount of notes that can be imported from a previously exported file is limited by the amount of memory available to the application. If you find that the application dies when importing a file, try splitting the file into two or more smaller files, copying the ‘<Metadata>’ and ‘<Categories>’ sections into each file, and import them separately.
- When importing a backup file, the progress bar may not update properly.

The following bugs were in the 1.5.0 release (built 2025.12.27) but have been fixed as of 1.5.1 (built 2025.12.28).

- If “Show private records” is set in the Settings but a password has not been entered, encrypted records are not shown.

The following bugs were in the 1.4.0 release (built 2025.03.27) but have been fixed as of 1.5.0 (built 2025.12.27).

- It is not possible to delete the last remaining category in the category list.

The following bugs were in the 1.3.0 release (built 2015.05.10) but have been fixed as of 1.3.1 (built 2025.03.16).

- If you press the back button while editing a note, all changes are discarded without warning.